MINOR B

League age 6 to 8 | 10" safety ball | Coach pitches from 30 to 35 ft | Up to 10 fielders

The first year after T-Ball. A coach pitches, every girl bats every inning, and every girl learns to throw, catch, hit and run the bases.

PURPOSE PROPOSAL

Minor B is where girls fall in love with softball. By the end of the season, every girl can throw to a teammate, catch a soft throw, hit a ball pitched by a coach, and run the bases the right way.

Scores are not reported in Minor B. The win is a girl who wants to come back next year.

HOW A MINOR B GAME WORKS DISTRICT 10 RULE

- A coach from the batting team pitches underhand from 30 to 35 ft. The coach can't field the ball.
- A girl plays the pitcher spot, within 5 ft of the coach, and fields like an infielder.
- Each batter gets 7 pitches. No walks, no strikeouts, no hit by pitch. If she fouls off the 7th pitch, she keeps batting.
- The half inning ends at 3 outs, 5 runs, or when every girl has batted.
- Runners stop when the defense stops the ball. No stealing and no bunting.
- Up to 10 fielders: no more than 6 in the infield, and outfielders at least 10 ft behind the infielders.
- No girl sits on the bench more than one inning in a row. No on-deck batter.
- No new inning after 1 hour 30 minutes. Games run Mar 30 to Jun 1.

WHAT LITTLE LEAGUE SAYS LITTLE LEAGUE

- Little League runs one Minor League Softball division for ages 5 to 11. Each local league splits it into levels by age and ability, such as coach pitch and player pitch. Minor B is the BLS coach pitch level.
- The Minors field: 60 ft bases and a 35 ft pitching distance.
- Coach training at this level centers on basic ball handling and batting skills.
- Practices should be short enough to keep players attentive and engaged.
- Little League's stated aim is growing well-rounded kids, not building elite ballplayers.

FOCUS SKILLS PROPOSAL

1. **Throwing.** Grip across the seams, point the glove at the target, step and throw overhand.
2. **Catching a throw.** Two hands, glove open, thumbs together above the waist, pinkies together below it.
3. **Fielding a ground ball.** Get in front of it, glove down on the ground, then throw.
4. **Hitting.** Feet apart, eyes on the ball, a level swing. Off a tee, a soft toss, then a coach pitching.
5. **Running the bases.** Drop the bat, run through first, touch every base, and stop when the ball is stopped.

BY THE END OF THE SEASON PROPOSAL

- Every girl can catch a soft throw with two hands.
- Every girl can field a ground ball and throw it to first base.
- Every girl hits the ball on most at-bats against a coach pitching.
- Every girl runs through first base and knows which base comes next.
- Every girl has played both infield and outfield in a game.

NOT ENOUGH, TOO MUCH PROPOSAL

NOT ENOUGH

- Girls stand in long lines and touch the ball a few times a practice.
- The same girls play infield every game.
- Practice is mostly batting practice.
- Nobody shows the girls how to hold a glove or where to throw.

TOO MUCH

- Teaching game situations the way a Majors team would.
- Long talks while the girls stand still.
- More than 2 team practices a week.
- Fixing every part of a swing at once. Pick one thing.

A 75-MINUTE PRACTICE PROPOSAL

Warm up + throw 15	Stations 35	Game play 15	Fun finish 10

- **Stations:** catching, ground balls, hitting off a tee and soft toss. Groups of 3 or 4. Rotate every 11 or 12 minutes.
- **Game play:** running the bases, where to throw after a ground ball.
- **Fun finish:** a relay race or a short scrimmage, so every girl leaves smiling.

COACH'S ROLE PROPOSAL

- Keep every girl moving. Small groups, lots of turns with the ball.
- Praise effort and hustle out loud, by name.
- Tell parents at the first meeting that Minor B is about learning the game and having fun. Scores are not kept for standings.